

Vegetarian Diet

Cutting out meat does not mean giving up protein, flavor or feeling full. A well-built vegetarian diet is light, cheap and full of fiber — and it can speed up your weight loss, as long as you make sure you have a good protein source at every meal. Here you have **20 options**, spread evenly between breakfast, lunch, dinner, dessert and drinks.

WHERE THE PROTEIN COMES FROM

- **Eggs** — a complete protein that is very filling.
- **Dairy** — plain yogurt, white cheese, ricotta, cottage cheese.
- **Legumes** — beans, lentils, chickpeas and peas.
- **Tofu** — made from soy, full of protein and low in fat.
- **Nuts and seeds** — walnuts, almonds and peanut butter (in moderation).

A golden tip: pair a **legume** with a **grain** in the same meal (rice with beans, chickpeas with rice) and you get a protein as complete as the one from meat.

How to use this: build your day by picking from this list 1 breakfast, 1 lunch, 1 dinner, 1 dessert and 1 drink. The breakfast, dessert and drink options are already in your book — just look for the recipe number. The vegetarian lunches and dinners are the **4 + 4 new recipes** that come right after.

FROM THE BOOK ITSELF

These recipes you already have are naturally vegetarian — use them as much as you want within this diet.

BREAKFASTS

Recipe 001	Banana Oat Pancakes
Recipe 003	Greek Yogurt with Berries and Oats
Recipe 007	Oat Porridge with Banana and Peanut Butter
Recipe 015	Mushroom and Spinach Omelette

DESSERTS

Recipe 102	Chocolate Avocado Mousse
Recipe 106	Creamy Banana Nice Cream
Recipe 110	Homemade Fruit Jelly
Recipe 116	Fit Berry Cheesecake (No Bake)

SMOOTHIES AND JUICES

Recipe 121	Green Detox Juice
Recipe 131	Banana Smoothie with Oats and Cinnamon
Recipe 133	Mixed Berry Smoothie
Recipe 135	Avocado Smoothie

BONUS 1 · VEGETARIAN DIET

VEGETARIAN LUNCHES AND DINNERS

The recipes that follow are new and made with no meat and no fish — the protein comes from legumes, tofu, eggs and cheese. Each one brings the adjustment table by profile, like the recipes in the book.

Chickpea Bowl with Rice and Roasted Vegetables

A colorful and generous bowl, with no meat at all — chickpeas carry you through the whole afternoon like a plate of protein.

**35 min**

TIME

1 serving

MAKES

~500

BASE KCAL

INGREDIENTS (BASE SERVING)

- 1/2 cup cooked chickpeas (or canned, drained)
- 4 tbsp cooked brown rice
- 1 zucchini in pieces
- 1/2 bell pepper in pieces
- 1/2 red onion in pieces
- cherry tomatoes
- 1 tsp olive oil
- juice of 1/2 lemon
- salt, pepper, turmeric and oregano to taste
- green leaves

HOW TO MAKE IT

- 1 Turn the oven to medium-high heat (400 °F). Cut the zucchini, the bell pepper and the onion into similar bite-sized pieces.
- 2 On a baking tray, spread the vegetables and the cherry tomatoes, season with salt, pepper, oregano and half of the olive oil, and mix with your hands.
- 3 Bake for 20 to 25 minutes, until the vegetables are soft and golden at the edges. Turn them halfway through.
- 4 In a pan, heat the rest of the olive oil and sauté the chickpeas with the turmeric, salt and pepper for 3 minutes, stirring, just to take in the flavor and brown lightly.
- 5 Build the bowl: a bed of green leaves, the rice on one side, the chickpeas and the roasted vegetables on top. Drizzle with the lemon juice and serve.

Adjust your serving

find your row and follow these amounts

PROFILE	TARGET FOR THIS MEAL	YOUR SERVING
WOMEN		
120–155 lb	~360 kcal	1/3 cup chickpeas · 3 tbsp rice · vegetables
156–185 lb	~440 kcal	1/2 cup chickpeas · 4 tbsp rice · vegetables
186–220 lb	~500 kcal	1/2 cup chickpeas · 5 tbsp rice · vegetables
220 lb +	~560 kcal	2/3 cup chickpeas · 5 tbsp rice · a little olive oil
MEN		
155–185 lb	~540 kcal	2/3 cup chickpeas · 5 tbsp rice · vegetables
186–220 lb	~610 kcal	3/4 cup chickpeas · 6 tbsp rice · 1 tbsp nuts
221–265 lb	~680 kcal	1 cup chickpeas · 7 tbsp rice · avocado
265 lb +	~750 kcal	1 cup chickpeas · 8 tbsp rice · avocado
Find your row by sex and weight and follow these amounts. Vegetables, salad greens, coffee and tea without sugar are free, as much as you want — you don't need to count them.		

WHY THIS HELPS YOU LOSE WEIGHT

Chickpeas combine protein and fiber that fill you up like a plate of meat, and together with brown rice they form a complete protein (the legume + grain pair that vegetarians use). Roasting the vegetables concentrates the flavor with no fat, keeping the plate light and full of taste.

Approximate values, calculated from a standard nutrition table — they are a guide, not a medical prescription. The targets per profile assume light activity; anyone who moves more burns more and can adjust upward.

Lentil Pie with Mashed Potato

All the comfort of a browned shepherd's pie, with a seasoned lentil filling instead of meat — creamy and full of plant protein.

**45 min**

TIME

2 servings

MAKES

~470

BASE KCAL

INGREDIENTS (BASE SERVING)

- 1 cup cooked lentils
- 2 medium potatoes
- 1 onion, chopped
- 2 cloves of garlic, chopped
- 1 tomato, chopped
- 1 carrot, grated
- 1 tsp olive oil
- 2 tbsp grated cheese
- salt, pepper, turmeric and fresh herbs to taste

HOW TO MAKE IT

- 1 Peel and cook the potatoes in boiling water for 15 minutes, until they are very soft. Drain and mash them with a fork, with a pinch of salt, until it turns into a smooth mash.
- 2 In a pan, heat the olive oil and fry the onion and the garlic for 2 minutes. Add the grated carrot and the tomato and cook for 3 minutes.
- 3 Add the cooked lentils, the turmeric, salt and pepper and cook for another 5 minutes, mashing the lentils a little with the spoon, until it makes a rich filling.
- 4 In a baking dish, spread half of the mash on the bottom, the lentil filling in the middle and the rest of the mash on top. Sprinkle the grated cheese.
- 5 Bake at medium-high heat (400 °F) for 15 minutes, until the surface is golden. Sprinkle fresh herbs and serve.

Adjust your serving

find your row and follow these amounts

PROFILE	TARGET FOR THIS MEAL	YOUR SERVING
WOMEN		
120–155 lb	~360 kcal	1/2 serving · salad
156–185 lb	~440 kcal	1 serving · salad
186–220 lb	~500 kcal	1 serving · salad
220 lb +	~560 kcal	1 serving · 1 more tbsp cheese · salad
MEN		
155–185 lb	~540 kcal	1 serving · extra lentils · salad
186–220 lb	~610 kcal	1 large serving · salad
221–265 lb	~680 kcal	1 large serving · extra lentils · salad
265 lb +	~750 kcal	double serving · salad
Find your row by sex and weight and follow these amounts. Vegetables, salad greens, coffee and tea without sugar are free, as much as you want — you don't need to count them.		

WHY THIS HELPS YOU LOSE WEIGHT

Lentils are rich in iron, fiber and plant protein, a trio that fills you up a lot — in the pie, they replace meat with room to spare. With the mashed potato in the right measure and a little browned cheese, it is a comforting plate that tricks the craving for heavy food.

Approximate values, calculated from a standard nutrition table — they are a guide, not a medical prescription. The targets per profile assume light activity; anyone who moves more burns more and can adjust upward.

Vegetable Frittata

A tall, fluffy omelette, baked with colorful vegetables and cheese — egg protein in a dish you cut into slices and everyone likes.

**30 min**

TIME

2 servings

MAKES

~420

BASE KCAL

INGREDIENTS (BASE SERVING)

- 5 eggs
- 1 zucchini in small cubes
- 1/2 bell pepper, chopped
- 1 tomato, chopped
- a handful of spinach
- 3 tbsp white cheese in cubes
- 1 tsp olive oil
- chives, salt and pepper to taste
- green leaves for the salad

HOW TO MAKE IT

- 1 Turn the oven to medium heat (350 °F). In an oven-safe pan, heat the olive oil and sauté the zucchini and the bell pepper for 4 minutes, stirring, until they soften.
- 2 Add the spinach and stir for 1 minute, just until it wilts (the leaves go soft). Spread the vegetables around the pan.
- 3 In a bowl, beat the eggs with salt and pepper. Add the tomato, the cheese and the chives and mix.
- 4 Pour the eggs over the vegetables in the pan and leave it 2 minutes on the heat, just to set the edge.
- 5 Put the pan in the oven for 15 minutes, until the frittata puffs up, sets in the center and browns on top. Cut it into slices and serve with a green salad.

Adjust your serving

find your row and follow these amounts

PROFILE	TARGET FOR THIS MEAL	YOUR SERVING
WOMEN		
120–155 lb	~360 kcal	1 slice · salad
156–185 lb	~440 kcal	1 large slice · salad
186–220 lb	~500 kcal	1 large slice · salad · 2 tbsp rice
220 lb +	~560 kcal	2 slices · salad · 2 tbsp rice
MEN		
155–185 lb	~540 kcal	2 slices · salad · 3 tbsp rice
186–220 lb	~610 kcal	2 large slices · salad · 3 tbsp rice
221–265 lb	~680 kcal	2 large slices · salad · 4 tbsp rice
265 lb +	~750 kcal	3 slices · salad · 4 tbsp rice
Find your row by sex and weight and follow these amounts. Vegetables, salad greens, coffee and tea without sugar are free, as much as you want — you don't need to count them.		

WHY THIS HELPS YOU LOSE WEIGHT

Eggs are a complete and very filling protein, ideal for a vegetarian lunch with no legumes. Baked with vegetables and a little cheese, the frittata goes a long way, keeps well in the fridge and kills hunger in a light and nourishing way.

Approximate values, calculated from a standard nutrition table — they are a guide, not a medical prescription. The targets per profile assume light activity; anyone who moves more burns more and can adjust upward.

Vegetarian Bean and Chickpea Chili

A spicy, hearty stew with no meat at all — proof that vegetarian food also fills the plate and your belly.



30 min
TIME

3 servings
MAKES

~460
BASE KCAL

INGREDIENTS (BASE SERVING)

- 1 cup cooked red beans
- 1 cup cooked chickpeas
- 1/2 cup corn
- 1 onion, chopped
- 2 cloves of garlic, chopped
- 1 bell pepper, chopped
- 2 tomatoes, chopped (or tomato sauce)
- 1 tsp olive oil
- 1 tsp cumin
- salt, pepper and paprika to taste
- rice to serve

HOW TO MAKE IT

- 1 Heat the olive oil in a pot over medium heat. Fry the onion, the garlic and the bell pepper for 3 minutes, stirring, until they soften.
- 2 Add the cumin, the paprika, salt and pepper and stir for 30 seconds, so the spices release their aroma.
- 3 Add the chopped tomatoes and cook for 5 minutes, until they break down into a sauce.
- 4 Add the red beans, the chickpeas and the corn. If it gets dry, add half a cup of water.
- 5 Turn the heat down and cook for 15 minutes, stirring now and then, until it thickens into a creamy stew. Serve with a little rice.

Adjust your serving

find your row and follow these amounts

PROFILE	TARGET FOR THIS MEAL	YOUR SERVING
WOMEN		
120–155 lb	~360 kcal	1/2 serving · 3 tbsp rice
156–185 lb	~440 kcal	1 serving · 4 tbsp rice
186–220 lb	~500 kcal	1 serving · 5 tbsp rice
220 lb +	~560 kcal	1 serving · 5 tbsp rice · avocado
MEN		
155–185 lb	~540 kcal	1 serving · 5 tbsp rice
186–220 lb	~610 kcal	1 large serving · 6 tbsp rice
221–265 lb	~680 kcal	large serving · 7 tbsp rice · avocado
265 lb +	~750 kcal	double serving · 8 tbsp rice
Find your row by sex and weight and follow these amounts. Vegetables, salad greens, coffee and tea without sugar are free, as much as you want — you don't need to count them.		

WHY THIS HELPS YOU LOSE WEIGHT

Beans and chickpeas together form a very complete plant protein, with a mountain of fiber that fills you up for hours. Served with rice, it closes the complete protein. It is a cheap plate that lasts several days and proves you can eat well with no meat.

Approximate values, calculated from a standard nutrition table — they are a guide, not a medical prescription. The targets per profile assume light activity; anyone who moves more burns more and can adjust upward.

Hearty Lentil Soup with Vegetables

A soup that is a real meal: the lentils make the broth rich and full of protein, warming and filling you up on a cold night.



40 min
TIME

3 servings
MAKES

~380
BASE KCAL

INGREDIENTS (BASE SERVING)

- 1 cup raw lentils
- 1 potato in cubes
- 1 carrot in cubes
- 1 celery stalk, chopped (optional)
- 1 tomato, chopped
- 1 onion, chopped
- 2 cloves of garlic, chopped
- 1 tsp olive oil
- salt, pepper, turmeric and fresh herbs to taste
- 5 cups of water

HOW TO MAKE IT

- 1 Wash the lentils. In a pot, heat the olive oil and fry the onion and the garlic for 2 minutes, stirring.
- 2 Add the tomato, the carrot, the potato and the celery and stir for 2 minutes.
- 3 Add the lentils, the turmeric, salt, pepper and the water. Bring it to a boil.
- 4 Turn the heat down and cook for 25 to 30 minutes, stirring now and then, until the lentils and the vegetables are very soft and the broth has body. If it dries up too much, add a little hot water.
- 5 Check the salt, sprinkle fresh herbs and serve very hot.

Adjust your serving

find your row and follow these amounts

PROFILE	TARGET FOR THIS MEAL	YOUR SERVING
WOMEN		
120–155 lb	~340 kcal	1 ladle · no bread
156–185 lb	~420 kcal	2 ladles · no bread
186–220 lb	~480 kcal	2 ladles · 1 slice bread
220 lb +	~540 kcal	2 ladles · 1 slice bread
MEN		
155–185 lb	~520 kcal	2 ladles · 1 slice bread
186–220 lb	~590 kcal	3 ladles · 1 slice bread
221–265 lb	~650 kcal	3 ladles · 2 slices bread
265 lb +	~720 kcal	3 large ladles · 2 slices bread
Find your row by sex and weight and follow these amounts. Vegetables, salad greens, coffee and tea without sugar are free, as much as you want — you don't need to count them.		

WHY THIS HELPS YOU LOSE WEIGHT

Lentils are one of the legumes richest in protein and iron, and in a soup they make the broth hearty enough to be a complete dinner with no meat. All that liquid and the vegetables fill your stomach with few calories — light, warm and comforting.

Approximate values, calculated from a standard nutrition table — they are a guide, not a medical prescription. The targets per profile assume light activity; anyone who moves more burns more and can adjust upward.

Grilled Tofu with Vegetables and Rice

The golden tofu takes in the seasoning and turns out delicious — a meat-free option that really fills you up and is light for the evening.



25 min
TIME

1 serving
MAKES

~420
BASE KCAL

INGREDIENTS (BASE SERVING)

- 5 oz firm tofu in slices
- 4 tbsp cooked brown rice
- 1 cup of broccoli and carrot
- 1 tbsp light soy sauce
- 1 clove of garlic, chopped
- 1 tsp olive oil
- grated ginger (optional)
- salt and pepper to taste

HOW TO MAKE IT

- 1 Dry the tofu slices well with paper towel, pressing lightly — the drier it is, the better it browns.
- 2 Season the tofu with the soy sauce, the garlic and the ginger. Let it take in the flavor for 5 minutes.
- 3 Heat a nonstick pan with half of the olive oil over medium-high heat. Grill the tofu slices for 3 to 4 minutes on each side, without moving them, until a golden crust forms. Take them out and set them aside.
- 4 Cut the broccoli into florets and the carrot into rounds. In the same pan, with the rest of the olive oil, sauté the vegetables for 4 minutes, until they are tender but still firm.
- 5 Build the plate with the brown rice, the vegetables and the grilled tofu on top. Drizzle with a little more soy sauce if you like.

Adjust your serving

find your row and follow these amounts

PROFILE	TARGET FOR THIS MEAL	YOUR SERVING
WOMEN		
120–155 lb	~340 kcal	4 oz tofu · 3 tbsp rice · vegetables
156–185 lb	~420 kcal	5 oz tofu · 4 tbsp rice · vegetables
186–220 lb	~480 kcal	5 oz tofu · 5 tbsp rice · vegetables
220 lb +	~540 kcal	6 oz tofu · 5 tbsp rice · a little olive oil
MEN		
155–185 lb	~520 kcal	6 oz tofu · 5 tbsp rice · vegetables
186–220 lb	~590 kcal	7 oz tofu · 6 tbsp rice · vegetables
221–265 lb	~650 kcal	8 oz tofu · 7 tbsp rice · 1 tbsp nuts
265 lb +	~720 kcal	9 oz tofu · 8 tbsp rice · nuts
Find your row by sex and weight and follow these amounts. Vegetables, salad greens, coffee and tea without sugar are free, as much as you want — you don't need to count them.		

WHY THIS HELPS YOU LOSE WEIGHT

Tofu is made from soy and brings plant protein with little fat, making it one of the best options for a change from meat. Dried well and grilled, it gains texture and takes in the seasoning. With vegetables and brown rice, it becomes a complete, light dinner full of fiber.

Approximate values, calculated from a standard nutrition table — they are a guide, not a medical prescription. The targets per profile assume light activity; anyone who moves more burns more and can adjust upward.

Eggplant Stuffed with Chickpeas and Cheese

The eggplant itself becomes the bowl, stuffed with seasoned chickpeas and browned with cheese — pretty, generous and meat-free.

**40 min**

TIME

2 servings

MAKES

~400

BASE KCAL

INGREDIENTS (BASE SERVING)

- 1 large eggplant
- 1 cup cooked chickpeas
- 1 onion, chopped
- 1 clove of garlic, chopped
- 1 tomato, chopped
- 1 tsp olive oil
- 2 tbsp grated low-fat cheese
- salt, pepper, cumin and parsley to taste

HOW TO MAKE IT

- 1 Turn the oven to medium-high heat (400 °F). Cut the eggplant in half lengthwise. With a spoon, take out part of the middle, making two 'boats'. Chop the part you took out.
- 2 Put the boats on a baking tray, drizzle with a little olive oil and bake for 10 minutes, just to soften them.
- 3 In a pan, heat the rest of the olive oil and fry the onion and the garlic for 2 minutes. Add the tomato, the chopped eggplant middle, the chickpeas, the cumin, salt and pepper and cook for 6 minutes, mashing the chickpeas a little, until it makes a soft filling.
- 4 Fill the boats with the chickpea mixture and sprinkle the grated cheese on top.
- 5 Put it back in the oven for 15 minutes, until the top browns (the cheese melts and goes golden). Sprinkle parsley and serve.

Adjust your serving

find your row and follow these amounts

PROFILE	TARGET FOR THIS MEAL	YOUR SERVING
WOMEN		
120–155 lb	~340 kcal	1/2 eggplant · salad
156–185 lb	~420 kcal	1 stuffed eggplant · salad
186–220 lb	~480 kcal	1 eggplant · 2 tbsp rice
220 lb +	~540 kcal	1 eggplant · extra chickpeas · salad
MEN		
155–185 lb	~520 kcal	1 eggplant · extra chickpeas · 2 tbsp rice
186–220 lb	~590 kcal	1 large eggplant · 3 tbsp rice
221–265 lb	~650 kcal	1 eggplant · double chickpeas · 4 tbsp rice
265 lb +	~720 kcal	eggplant + extra portion · 4 tbsp rice
Find your row by sex and weight and follow these amounts. Vegetables, salad greens, coffee and tea without sugar are free, as much as you want — you don't need to count them.		

WHY THIS HELPS YOU LOSE WEIGHT

Eggplant has a lot of water and fiber, so it fills the plate with very few calories. The chickpeas bring the plant protein that replaces meat, and a little browned cheese kills the craving for a cheesy dish. A pretty, generous and light vegetarian dinner.

Approximate values, calculated from a standard nutrition table — they are a guide, not a medical prescription. The targets per profile assume light activity; anyone who moves more burns more and can adjust upward.

Chickpea Curry with Rice

A golden, fragrant sauce wrapping around the chickpeas — creamy with light coconut milk, it is a vegetarian dinner full of flavor.



30 min
TIME

2 servings
MAKES

~440
BASE KCAL

INGREDIENTS (BASE SERVING)

- 2 cups cooked chickpeas
- 1 onion, chopped
- 2 cloves of garlic, chopped
- 1 tomato, chopped
- 1 tsp curry powder
- 1/2 cup light coconut milk
- a handful of spinach (optional)
- 1 tsp olive oil
- salt, pepper and coriander to taste
- rice to serve

HOW TO MAKE IT

- 1 Heat the olive oil in a pot over medium heat and fry the onion and the garlic for 2 minutes, stirring.
- 2 Add the curry and stir for 30 seconds, so the spice releases its aroma. Add the tomato and cook for 3 minutes, until it breaks down.
- 3 Add the chickpeas and the light coconut milk and mix. Season with salt and pepper.
- 4 Cook over low heat for 10 minutes, stirring now and then, until the sauce thickens. If you like, add the spinach in the last 2 minutes, just until it wilts.
- 5 Sprinkle coriander and serve over a portion of rice.

Adjust your serving

find your row and follow these amounts

PROFILE	TARGET FOR THIS MEAL	YOUR SERVING
WOMEN		
120–155 lb	~340 kcal	2/3 cup chickpeas · 3 tbsp rice
156–185 lb	~420 kcal	1 cup chickpeas · 4 tbsp rice
186–220 lb	~480 kcal	1 cup chickpeas · 5 tbsp rice
220 lb +	~540 kcal	1 cup chickpeas · 5 tbsp rice · spinach
MEN		
155–185 lb	~520 kcal	1 cup chickpeas · 5 tbsp rice
186–220 lb	~590 kcal	1 1/2 cups chickpeas · 6 tbsp rice
221–265 lb	~650 kcal	1 1/2 cups chickpeas · 7 tbsp rice
265 lb +	~720 kcal	2 cups chickpeas · 8 tbsp rice
Find your row by sex and weight and follow these amounts. Vegetables, salad greens, coffee and tea without sugar are free, as much as you want — you don't need to count them.		

WHY THIS HELPS YOU LOSE WEIGHT

Chickpeas are rich in protein and fiber, and in a curry they turn creamy and full of flavor. Light coconut milk gives the sauce its richness with far less fat than cream. With rice, it forms a complete protein — a comforting and nourishing vegetarian dinner.

Approximate values, calculated from a standard nutrition table — they are a guide, not a medical prescription. The targets per profile assume light activity; anyone who moves more burns more and can adjust upward.